



Residential Power Washing & Soft Washing

Professional Process Guide

For homeowners who want the house cleaned properly, not blasted.

Driveways & Walkways + Siding & Brick Soft Wash + Patios & Interlock + Roof & Gutter Exteriors

PREPARED EXCLUSIVELY FOR

Client Name _____
Property Address _____
Phone _____
Email _____

What's Included

A complete exterior wash for your home: pressure matched to every surface, commercial DEWALT and Simpson gas units running up to 4400 PSI on concrete, and low pressure soft washing with proper detergent on siding, brick and stucco. Pre-wash walkthrough, plant and landscape protection, full rinse down, and a final inspection with you before we leave the property.



Vinyl siding soft wash, London Ontario. Algae and black mould removed at the root without warping a single panel.

Why This Process Matters

Pressure Is Not the Skill. Matching It Is.

Almost every power washing complaint comes from the same mistake: one pressure setting used on every surface. Concrete can take 4000 PSI without any issue. Vinyl siding cannot. Hit siding at driveway pressure and water is forced up behind the panels, into the wall cavity and around window seals. The panels warp, the paint on the trim strips, and the moisture problem does not show up until months later.

Core Exteriors runs commercial DEWALT and Simpson gas units up to 4400 PSI, but the units are only part of it. We change the tip, the distance, the detergent and the method for each surface on your property. High pressure on concrete and pavers. Low pressure soft wash with a cleaning solution on siding, brick, stucco and roofing. That is the difference between a house that looks clean and a house that gets damaged in the process.

The Complete Package

- Pre-wash walkthrough with you to confirm every surface in scope and flag anything fragile
- Driveways, walkways, sidewalks and steps washed at full pressure to lift oil, rust and grime
- Siding, brick and stucco soft washed with a matched detergent that kills algae at the root
- Patios, interlock and pool decks cleaned including joints and border stones
- Fascia, soffit, eavestrough exteriors and downspouts brightened as part of the house wash
- Plants, gardens, light fixtures, outlets and furniture protected before any water is turned on
- Full property rinse down, debris cleared, and a walkthrough with you before we leave

What You Can Expect: 7 Phases

- Phase 1 - Site assessment, surface identification and before photo documentation
- Phase 2 - Property protection, plant saturation and equipment staging
- Phase 3 - Pre-treatment and detergent dwell on organic growth
- Phase 4 - Soft wash of siding, brick, stucco, fascia and soffit
- Phase 5 - High pressure wash of concrete, pavers and hard surfaces
- Phase 6 - Full rinse down, spot treatment and touch up pass
- Phase 7 - Final inspection, walkthrough and after photo documentation

Pricing & Timeline

Every power washing job is quoted after a free on site walkthrough. Square footage, surface type, how much organic growth has built up, water access and how many stories the house is all change the number. The ranges below are what most London area homes fall into so you have a realistic starting point before we visit.

Driveway or walkway wash (concrete or asphalt)	From \$0.25 / sq ft
Full house soft wash (siding, brick or stucco)	From \$0.30 / sq ft
Interlock or paver patio wash	From \$0.35 / sq ft
Deck or fence surface wash	From \$0.40 / sq ft
Full exterior package (house, driveway, walkways, patio)	Bundled rate

Bundling services on one visit is always cheaper than booking them separately. Setup, water access and equipment staging happen once instead of three times, and we pass that saving on. Core Exteriors runs about 20 percent below franchise pricing because we carry no franchise fees.

Typical Timeline

A standard London area two storey home with a driveway, front walkway and a back patio is a single day job, usually four to six hours on site. A driveway only wash is two to three hours. Larger properties, heavy algae growth or multiple hard surfaces can run into a second day. We confirm the estimated schedule with you at the time of quote and we call ahead if weather moves the date.

Which Service Does Your Property Need?

Not every home needs the full package. Every job starts with a free walkthrough so we can confirm the right scope in person, with no obligation. Call 519-712-1431.

IF THIS SOUNDS LIKE YOUR PROPERTY	WHAT YOU LIKELY NEED
Green or black streaking down the siding, especially on the north facing wall.	House soft wash. This is algae, not dirt, and it needs detergent.
Driveway is dark, blotchy, or has oil and rust staining near the garage.	High pressure driveway wash with a surface cleaner and degreaser.
Patio or walkway pavers look dull with weeds and moss in the joints.	Paver wash. Ask about polymeric sand top up at the same visit.
Black streaks running down from the roof line onto the shingles.	Roof soft wash. Never high pressure on shingles.

Step by Step Process

Below is exactly what happens on a Core Exteriors residential power washing job, from the first walkthrough to the final inspection. Every step is sequenced, and we always work top down so nothing clean gets dirtied again by runoff from

PHASE 1

Site Assessment & Surface Identification

Before any water is turned on, we identify every surface and confirm what method each one gets. Getting this wrong is what damages homes.

1.1 Surface Inventory

We walk the full property and identify every material in scope: vinyl, aluminum, brick, stucco, wood, concrete, asphalt, interlock, composite. Each one gets a different pressure, tip and detergent, so the inventory drives the entire job plan.

1.2 Growth & Staining Diagnosis

We identify what we are actually removing. Green growth is algae. Black streaking is usually *gloeocapsa magma*. Orange staining is rust or iron in the water table. Dark spots on concrete are oil or tannin from leaves. Each one needs a different treatment, and some need dwell time.

1.3 Vulnerability Check

We flag anything that needs protecting or avoiding: failing caulk around windows, loose or cracked siding panels, lifting paint, exposed outlets, damaged screens, older wood windows, and any gaps where water could get behind the envelope. We point these out to you before we start.

1.4 Water & Access Confirmation

We confirm spigot location, water pressure and volume, and plan hose routing so lines are not run across walkways you need. If water volume is low we bring a buffer tank rather than run the machine dry.

1.5 Before Photo Documentation

Dated wide and close up photos of every affected surface. These are your record and our quality benchmark at final inspection.

PHASE 2

Property Protection & Staging

Protecting your property is not an afterthought at the end. It happens before the equipment comes off the truck.

2.1 Plant & Garden Saturation

Every garden bed, shrub and lawn edge within the spray zone is soaked with clean water first. Saturated foliage cannot absorb detergent runoff. Sensitive plantings get covered with tarps on top of that.

2.2 Electrical & Fixture Protection

Exterior outlets, light fixtures, doorbell cameras, AC units and any exposed wiring are covered and sealed before pressure goes anywhere near them.

2.3 Openings & Furniture

Windows and doors are checked closed. Patio furniture, grills, planters and decor are moved to a staging area clear of the work zone, and returned when the surface is dry.

2.4 Equipment Staging

Gas units, surface cleaners, soft wash tips, telescoping wands, detergent mixes and downstream injectors are staged in work

PHASE 3

Pre-Treatment & Detergent Dwell

This is the step most companies skip, and it is the reason their results come back within a season.

3.1 Why Chemistry Beats Pressure

Algae, mildew and lichen have root structures in the surface. Pressure alone shears the top off and leaves the root behind, which is why blasted siding looks clean for two months and then greens up again. A proper detergent kills the organism at the root so it has to start over.

3.2 Detergent Selection

The cleaning solution is mixed to the material. Vinyl, painted aluminum, brick, stucco and wood all get a different concentration. We never use a single mix across the whole house.

3.3 Controlled Application & Dwell

Solution is applied low pressure from the bottom up to prevent streaking, then given the manufacturer specified dwell time to work. We keep the surface wet through the dwell so nothing dries and bakes on.

3.4 Spot Treatment

Heavy areas, north facing walls, shaded corners and behind downspouts get a second application before the wash pass rather than being forced with pressure later.

PHASE 4

Soft Wash: Siding, Brick, Stucco & Trim

Soft washing is not a weaker version of pressure washing. It is a different method that relies on the solution doing the work.

4.1 Low Pressure, High Volume

Siding is washed at low pressure with high water volume, which rinses the killed growth away without forcing water behind the panels or up under the laps. The panels stay seated and the wall stays dry.

4.2 Top Down Sequence

We work roof line down: fascia and soffit first, then upper siding, then lower siding, then the foundation course. Runoff always falls onto a surface not yet cleaned, so nothing gets re-dirtied and no streaks are left behind.

4.3 Material Specific Handling

Vinyl is washed along the lap line, never up into it. Aluminum is handled to lift oxidation without scratching. Brick and mortar get treated for efflorescence and moss without etching. Stucco is cleaned thoroughly without pulling out the texture or opening hairline cracks.

4.4 Trim, Fascia, Soffit & Gutter Faces

The white oxidized streaking on eavestrough faces, known as tiger striping, needs a dedicated gutter brightener and hand

PHASE 5

High Pressure: Concrete, Pavers & Hard Surfaces

Once the house is done and rinsed, we move to the flat work where full pressure is the right tool.

5.1 Surface Cleaner, Not Wand Striping

Driveways and walkways are cleaned with a rotating surface cleaner, not a wand. A wand leaves zebra striping across the concrete that never fully evens out. The surface cleaner delivers uniform coverage with no lines.

5.2 Degreasing & Rust Treatment

Oil spots get a dedicated degreaser with dwell time before pressure. Rust and irrigation staining gets a separate rust remover. Neither one comes off with pressure alone regardless of PSI.

5.3 Edges, Steps & Detail Work

The surface cleaner cannot reach edges, expansion joints, step risers or curb faces. These are detailed by hand with a wand so the finished job has no missed border framing the clean area.

5.4 Interlock & Paver Caution

Pavers are cleaned at a controlled distance so joint sand is not blown out. Where sand is already washed out we will tell you, and recommend a polymeric sand top up rather than leaving open joints that fill with weeds.

PHASE 6

Rinse Down & Touch Up

The rinse is a real phase, not the tail end of the last one.

6.1 Full Property Rinse

Every washed surface, plus the plants, walkways, driveway and any adjacent hard surface carrying runoff, gets a complete clean water rinse. Detergent residue left to dry is what causes spotting and plant burn.

6.2 Landscape Flush

Garden beds and lawn edges are flushed a second time after the wash is complete. This is the step that keeps shrubs and grass healthy through the week following a wash.

6.3 Second Pass on Stubborn Areas

We walk the property while everything is still wet and re-treat anything that did not fully release. Some deep staining takes two applications, and it is easier to catch it now than to come back.

6.4 Debris & Site Clearing

Loosened debris, dead growth, leaves flushed out of corners and any material washed off the roof line is collected and removed

PHASE 7

Final Inspection & Walkthrough

We do not leave until the job meets our standard and you have seen the result.

7.1 Quality Inspection Checklist

We verify: all surfaces evenly cleaned with no streaking or striping, no missed sections at edges or behind downspouts, protections removed, furniture returned, fixtures uncovered, and all equipment and debris off the property.

7.2 Before & After Comparison

We review the Phase 1 photos alongside the finished surfaces with you so the change is documented rather than remembered.

7.3 Client Walkthrough & Sign Off

We walk the property with you, explain what was done on each surface and answer any questions. If something is not right we fix it on the spot. You sign off before we close the job file.

7.4 Aftercare Guidance

We explain what to expect over the following weeks, when the surface will be fully dry, and what maintenance interval makes sense for your property and tree cover.

Before & After

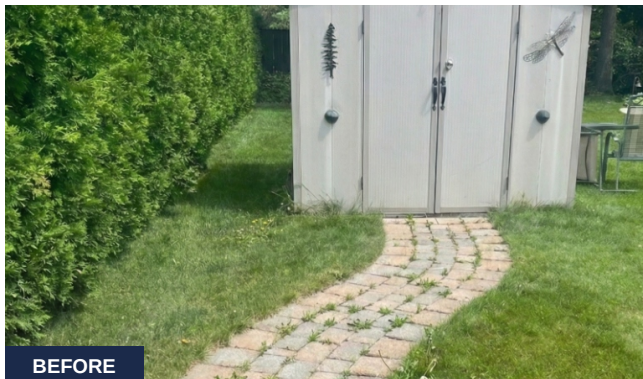
Real Core Exteriors residential jobs across London and surrounding areas.



Vinyl siding soft wash, London. Green algae and black mould removed at the root without warping a single panel.



Concrete driveway, Oakridge. Oil staining and embedded grime lifted with a surface cleaner for uniform coverage with no wand striping.



Interlock paver walkway, Westmount. Algae and surface staining removed at controlled pressure so joint sand stayed in place.

Questions Homeowners Ask Us

Will pressure washing damage my siding?

Not the way we do it. Siding is soft washed at low pressure with a cleaning solution doing the work, so nothing is forced behind the panels. Damage happens when a company uses driveway pressure on a wall. We never do that, and we identify every material on your property in Phase 1 specifically so it cannot happen.

How often should I have my house washed?

Most London area homes are on a two year cycle. If you have heavy tree cover, a north facing wall that stays shaded, or you are near the river, once a year keeps ahead of it. Driveways and walkways generally look best on an annual wash.

Is the detergent safe for my plants, pets and kids?

Yes, with the process we follow. We saturate every garden bed with clean water before we start, cover sensitive plantings, and flush the landscaping again after the wash. Surfaces are safe for pets and children as soon as they are dry, typically one to two hours in good weather.

Do you need access to my water and power?

We need an outdoor spigot. Our units are gas powered so we do not need your electricity. If your water volume is low we bring a buffer tank. We will confirm access during the walkthrough so there are no surprises on the day.

Do I need to be home during the service?

No. Many of our customers are at work. We need access to the spigot and the gates unlocked. We send before and after photos when the job is done and follow up to make sure you are happy with the result.

What happens if it rains on the scheduled day?

Light rain is not an issue for the wash itself, and rain does not undo the work. Heavy rain or high wind makes proper detergent application impossible, so we reschedule. We call you ahead of the appointment rather than leaving you waiting.

Will the black streaks on my roof come off?

Yes. Those streaks are algae, and they respond to a soft wash treatment. This is never done with high pressure because that dislodges granules and can void your shingle warranty. Our roof work is soft wash only and our crew is Working at Heights certified.

Can you get oil stains out of my driveway?

Usually, and often completely. Fresh oil comes out fully. Old stains that have soaked deep into porous concrete will lighten significantly but may not vanish entirely. We tell you honestly at the walkthrough what to expect rather than overpromising.

Why are you cheaper than the franchise that quoted me?

We are fully independent, so we pay no franchise royalties or corporate marketing levies. That is roughly a 20 percent difference and it comes off your price, not out of the work. We carry \$5M in liability insurance and are fully WSIB compliant.

What if I am not happy with the result?

We do not leave the site until you are 100 percent satisfied. If something is not right we fix it while we are there. If you notice something after we leave, call us and we come back.

Guarantee & Next Steps

The Job-Complete Guarantee

We do not leave the site until you are 100 percent satisfied with the work. Your satisfaction is the only measure of success we use. If something is not right, we correct it on the spot before we pack up. That has been the standard since we started in 2022 and it has not changed as we have grown.

Equipment & Products We Use

Commercial DEWALT and Simpson gas pressure units rated up to 4400 PSI, rotating surface cleaners for uniform concrete coverage, downstream injectors and dedicated soft wash tips for siding, telescoping wands for upper storeys, and professional grade cleaning solutions matched to each material. No consumer grade equipment goes on a Core Exteriors job.

Aftercare Essentials

- Surfaces are safe to walk on as soon as they are dry, typically one to two hours in good weather.
- Leave patio furniture off freshly cleaned pavers until fully dry to avoid transfer marks.
- Keep downspouts and drainage directed away from cleaned hard surfaces to slow re-staining.
- Trim back shrubs touching the siding. Constant contact is the fastest way to regrow algae.
- If you notice a spot we missed, call us within seven days and we return at no charge.

Credentials

- \$5 Million commercial general liability insurance
- Fully WSIB compliant with clearance certificate available on request
- Working at Heights certified crew for elevated and roof work
- HST registered, London Ontario based, operating since 2022
- Serving London. St. Thomas. Strathroy. Dorchester and surrounding communities

Ready to Book Your Free Walkthrough?

We will walk the property with you, identify every surface, tell you what actually needs doing and what does not, and prepare a written quote before any work begins. No obligation and no pressure to book on the spot.

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